

Remediation Scoring Model

A framework for estimating and prioritizing remediation work during database or application migration.

Matt DeMarco

matthew.demarco@oracle.com

Why? 🤔

A quantitative way to estimate how much work it will take to fix code during a migration

Complexity Levels

Level	Effort (hours)	Description
Easy	1	Simple changes or formatting
Medium	3	Moderate logic or syntax changes
Hard	8	Major rewrites or architecture

The Formula

$$\text{Remediation Score} = (w_E \times n_E) + (w_M \times n_M) + (w_H \times n_H)$$

Where:

- w_E , w_M , w_H are **weights in hours**
- n_E , n_M , n_H are **observed counts**

Example Calculation

Weights:

- Easy: 1 hr
- Medium: 3 hrs
- Hard: 8 hrs

Observed:

- Easy: 20
- Medium: 10
- Hard: 5

Result

$$\text{Remediation Score} = (1 \times 20) + (3 \times 10) + (8 \times 5) = 20 + 30 + 40 = 90 \text{hours}$$

Normalized Score

Used to compare different-sized systems

$$\text{Normalized Score} = \frac{\text{Remediation Score}}{n_E + n_M + n_H}$$

Example Normalization

$$\textit{TotalFixes} = 20 + 10 + 5 = 35$$

$$\textit{NormalizedScore} = 90/35 \approx 2.57$$

Why Normalize?

1. Fair Comparison

- Large and small systems can be compared equally

2. Effort Intensity

- See how difficult the average fix is

3. Better Prioritization

- Focus on modules with higher complexity per fix

Use Cases

- Estimate time and effort
- Inform staffing needs
- Set project timelines
- Prioritize remediation work

Adaptability

- Adjust weights for hours, cost, or risk
- Expand complexity levels if needed
- Automate using analysis tools

Output and Next Steps

- Higher score → more effort required
- Normalize to identify complexity intensity
- Use in combination with cost/time metrics

Available Tools

- Excel spreadsheet for custom inputs

Thank you
